

# ING's updated forecasts amid energy disruption

Our economists and strategists have updated their forecasts to reflect the rapidly changing events in the Middle East and our new base case scenario



Oil tankers and cargo ships are being forced to reroute as the Strait of Hormuz is effectively blocked

## Interim forecast update

The war in the Middle East continues, and the Strait of Hormuz is practically blocked. Our initial base case assumptions from our [March Monthly](#) regarding the war have become outdated. We are normally not in the business of permanently changing our forecasts, but given that our next Monthly Update is only due in April, and we think that these times currently require some guidance, we have updated our full set of [forecasts](#).

## Three new scenarios

We have developed [three new scenarios](#) to guide our thinking and macro and market forecasts. In summary:

- **Scenario 1** (our new base case): Intensive combat will end within the next two weeks, but will be followed by lower intensity strikes that linger for several months. It's a scenario in which the opening of the Strait of Hormuz will take much longer than initially anticipated.

The 'end game' in this scenario could be a temporary ceasefire or tacit stand down with maritime escorts and exploratory talks on sanctions. Regime change over time is still possible, driven from the inside, as in East Germany in the late 1980s.

- **Scenario 2** (optimistic alternative): War ends surprisingly earlier than in our new base case scenario and the Strait of Hormuz opens up within a short period.
- **Scenario 3** (longer war): Longer combat action followed by protracted, lower-grade, impulsive confrontation. That would imply a much more uncertain situation in the Strait. In this scenario, the 'end game' could be a hard won ceasefire with third party guarantees (likely involving Russia or China), the possibility of sequenced sanctions relief, and a maritime security regime for Hormuz. However, even then, a durable peace could remain elusive, and the region might settle into a fragile, flare up prone equilibrium.

In short, our base case scenario does not foresee structural damage to an oil or gas production facility. We are facing a delay in energy and other shipments, but not (yet) a structural reduction. Needless to say, if a delay lasts long enough, it can still lead to these structural reductions. Generally speaking and for the time being, this is still mainly a supply-side shock, pushing up inflation and posing new challenges for central banks. As a result, the upward revision to our inflation forecasts is clearly larger than the downward revisions of growth, and they also differ across regions. What these new scenarios mean for our market forecasts can also be found [here](#).

Contact us directly to discuss more details of the underlying scenarios and their implications.

## ING Global Forecasts

|                                         | 1Q26F | 2Q26F | 2026<br>3Q26F | 4Q26F | 2026F | 1Q27F | 2Q27F | 2027<br>3Q27F | 4Q27F | 2027F |
|-----------------------------------------|-------|-------|---------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|---------------|-------|-------|
| <b>United States</b>                    |       |       |               |       |       |       |       |               |       |       |
| GDP (% QoQ, ann)                        | 3.1   | 2.4   | 1.8           | 1.9   | 2.5   | 1.9   | 2.0   | 2.0           | 2.0   | 2.0   |
| CPI headline (% YoY, avg)               | 2.5   | 3.8   | 3.5           | 3.2   | 3.3   | 2.8   | 2.0   | 1.9           | 2.1   | 2.2   |
| Federal funds (% eop)                   | 3.75  | 3.75  | 3.50          | 3.25  | 3.25  | 3.25  | 3.25  | 3.25          | 3.25  | 3.25  |
| 3-month SOFR rate (% eop)               | 3.70  | 3.70  | 3.50          | 3.30  | 3.30  | 3.30  | 3.30  | 3.30          | 3.30  | 3.30  |
| 10-year interest rate (% eop)           | 4.20  | 4.30  | 4.20          | 4.15  | 4.15  | 4.15  | 4.25  | 4.25          | 4.30  | 4.30  |
| Fiscal balance (% of GDP)               |       |       |               |       | -6    |       |       |               |       | -6.1  |
| Gross public debt / GDP                 |       |       |               |       | 102.6 |       |       |               |       | 104.5 |
| <b>Eurozone</b>                         |       |       |               |       |       |       |       |               |       |       |
| GDP (% QoQ, ann)                        | 0.7   | 0.6   | 1.0           | 1.5   | 0.9   | 1.6   | 1.6   | 1.5           | 1.4   | 1.4   |
| CPI headline (% YoY, avg)               | 2.0   | 3.2   | 3.1           | 2.7   | 2.8   | 2.6   | 1.9   | 1.8           | 2.0   | 2.1   |
| ECB Deposit Rate (% eop)                | 2.00  | 2.00  | 2.00          | 2.00  | 2.00  | 2.00  | 2.00  | 2.00          | 2.00  | 2.00  |
| 3-month interest rate (% eop)           | 2.00  | 2.00  | 2.10          | 2.10  | 2.10  | 2.10  | 2.10  | 2.10          | 2.10  | 2.10  |
| 10-year interest rate (% eop)           | 3.00  | 3.00  | 2.95          | 2.85  | 2.85  | 2.90  | 3.00  | 3.00          | 3.10  | 3.10  |
| Fiscal balance (% of GDP)               |       |       |               |       | -3.6  |       |       |               |       | -3.5  |
| Gross public debt/GDP                   |       |       |               |       | 93    |       |       |               |       | 93.9  |
| <b>Japan</b>                            |       |       |               |       |       |       |       |               |       |       |
| GDP (% QoQ, ann)                        | 1.2   | 0.8   | 1.2           | 1.6   | 0.8   | 0.4   | 1.2   | 0.8           | 0.8   | 1.0   |
| CPI headline (% YoY, avg)               | 1.7   | 2.4   | 2.4           | 2.3   | 2.2   | 2.6   | 1.8   | 1.8           | 1.6   | 2.0   |
| Target rate (% eop)                     | 0.75  | 1.00  | 1.00          | 1.00  | 1.00  | 1.25  | 1.25  | 1.25          | 1.50  | 1.50  |
| 3-month interest rate (% eop)           | 1.20  | 1.20  | 1.20          | 1.35  | 1.35  | 1.50  | 1.50  | 1.70          | 1.75  | 1.75  |
| 10-year interest rate (% eop)           | 2.25  | 2.50  | 2.50          | 2.60  | 2.60  | 2.75  | 2.75  | 2.85          | 2.85  | 2.85  |
| Fiscal balance (% of GDP)               |       |       |               |       | -4.6  |       |       |               |       | -5.0  |
| Gross public debt/GDP                   |       |       |               |       | 230   |       |       |               |       | 228   |
| <b>China</b>                            |       |       |               |       |       |       |       |               |       |       |
| GDP (% YoY)                             | 4.6   | 4.6   | 4.7           | 4.5   | 4.6   | 4.2   | 4.9   | 4.4           | 4.4   | 4.5   |
| CPI headline (% YoY, avg)               | 0.9   | 1.1   | 1.4           | 1.3   | 1.2   | 1.6   | 1.1   | 1.1           | 1.1   | 1.3   |
| 7-day Reverse Repo Rate (% eop)         | 1.40  | 1.40  | 1.30          | 1.30  | 1.30  | 1.30  | 1.20  | 1.20          | 1.20  | 1.20  |
| 3M SHIBOR (% eop)                       | 1.55  | 1.50  | 1.45          | 1.45  | 1.45  | 1.45  | 1.45  | 1.45          | 1.45  | 1.45  |
| 10-year T-bond yield (% eop)            | 1.85  | 1.90  | 1.95          | 2.00  | 2.00  | 2.00  | 2.05  | 2.10          | 2.15  | 2.15  |
| Fiscal balance (% of GDP)               |       |       |               |       | -5.3  |       |       |               |       | -5.3  |
| Public debt (% of GDP), ind, local govt |       |       |               |       | 145   |       |       |               |       | -     |
| <b>United Kingdom</b>                   |       |       |               |       |       |       |       |               |       |       |
| GDP (% QoQ, ann)                        | 1.3   | 0.9   | -0.1          | 0.8   | 0.6   | 1.5   | 1.5   | 1.5           | 1.5   | 1.1   |
| CPI headline (% YoY, avg)               | 3.0   | 2.4   | 3.5           | 3.4   | 3.1   | 3.2   | 2.9   | 1.9           | 2.1   | 2.5   |
| BoE official bank rate (% eop)          | 3.75  | 3.50  | 3.25          | 3.25  | 3.25  | 3.25  | 3.25  | 3.25          | 3.25  | 3.25  |
| 3-month interest rate (% eop)           | 3.50  | 3.20  | 3.20          | 3.20  | 3.20  | 3.20  | 3.20  | 3.20          | 3.20  | 3.20  |
| 10-year interest rate (% eop)           | 4.70  | 4.60  | 4.50          | 4.30  | 4.30  | 4.30  | 4.40  | 4.40          | 4.40  | 4.40  |
| Fiscal balance (% of GDP)               |       |       |               |       | 3.6   |       |       |               |       | 3.1   |
| Public sector net debt (FY, %)          |       |       |               |       | 96.1  |       |       |               |       | 96.4  |
| EUR/USD (eop)                           | 1.15  | 1.16  | 1.18          | 1.20  | 1.20  | 1.20  | 1.20  | 1.20          | 1.20  | 1.20  |
| USD/JPY (eop)                           | 158   | 158   | 155           | 153   | 153   | 150   | 148   | 147           | 145   | 145   |
| USD/CNY (eop)                           | 6.90  | 6.87  | 6.82          | 6.80  | 6.80  | 6.78  | 6.75  | 6.75          | 6.70  | 6.70  |
| EUR/GBP (eop)                           | 0.87  | 0.88  | 0.89          | 0.90  | 0.90  | 0.90  | 0.90  | 0.90          | 0.90  | 0.90  |
| ICE Brent - US\$/bbl (average)          | 76    | 91    | 85            | 77    | 82    | 72    | 70    | 67            | 63    | 68    |
| Dutch TTF - EUR/MWh (average)           | 39    | 50    | 38            | 38    | 41    | 34    | 28    | 27            | 30    | 30    |

Source: ING forecasts

## GDP Forecasts

| QoQ% Annualised (avg) |       |       |       |       |       |       |       |       |       |       |
|-----------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
|                       | 1Q26F | 2Q26F | 3Q26F | 4Q26F | 1Q27F | 2Q27F | 3Q27F | 4Q27F | 2026F | 2027F |
| US                    | 3.1   | 2.4   | 1.8   | 1.9   | 1.9   | 2.0   | 2.0   | 2.0   | 2.5   | 2.0   |
| Japan                 | 1.2   | 0.8   | 1.2   | 1.6   | 0.4   | 1.2   | 0.8   | 0.8   | 0.8   | 1.0   |
| Germany               | -0.5  | 1.1   | 1.8   | 2.2   | 1.8   | 2.6   | 2.5   | 2.5   | 0.8   | 2.2   |
| France                | 0.6   | 0.4   | 0.4   | 0.6   | 1.2   | 1.4   | 1.6   | 1.2   | 0.8   | 1.0   |
| UK                    | 1.3   | 0.9   | -0.1  | 0.8   | 1.5   | 1.5   | 1.5   | 1.5   | 0.6   | 1.1   |
| Italy                 | 0.3   | 0.4   | 0.9   | 1.3   | 0.9   | 0.6   | 0.8   | 0.6   | 0.7   | 0.8   |
| Canada                | 1.8   | 1.5   | 1.4   | 1.6   | 2.2   | 2.0   | 2.1   | 2.0   | 1.1   | 1.9   |
| Australia             | 2.3   | 2.2   | 2.3   | 2.2   | 2.5   | 2.5   | 2.5   | 2.5   | 2.3   | 2.5   |
| Eurozone              | 0.7   | 0.6   | 1.0   | 1.5   | 1.6   | 1.6   | 1.5   | 1.4   | 0.9   | 1.4   |
| Austria               | 1.0   | 0.6   | 1.2   | 1.8   | 1.8   | 1.6   | 1.6   | 1.4   | 0.8   | 1.6   |
| Spain                 | 1.9   | 1.1   | 2.0   | 1.5   | 2.1   | 2.1   | 2.0   | 2.0   | 2.1   | 1.9   |
| Netherlands           | 0.9   | 0.9   | 1.5   | 1.6   | 1.4   | 1.5   | 1.1   | 1.0   | 1.4   | 1.4   |
| Belgium               | 0.8   | 0.4   | 1.2   | 1.4   | 1.3   | 1.3   | 1.2   | 1.4   | 0.8   | 1.2   |
| Greece                | 1.6   | 0.8   | 1.8   | 1.7   | 1.7   | 2.4   | 2.2   | 1.7   | 1.9   | 1.8   |
| Portugal              | 1.7   | 1.3   | 1.6   | 1.7   | 2.0   | 2.0   | 2.0   | 2.0   | 2.1   | 1.9   |
| Switzerland           | 1.2   | 0.6   | 0.8   | 1.2   | 1.2   | 1.6   | 1.6   | 1.2   | 0.5   | 1.2   |

| Emerging Markets, (YoY% growth) |       |       |       |       |       |       |       |       |       |       |
|---------------------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
|                                 | 1Q26F | 2Q26F | 3Q26F | 4Q26F | 1Q27F | 2Q27F | 3Q27F | 4Q27F | 2026F | 2027F |
| Bulgaria                        | 3.1   | 2.8   | 2.7   | 2.5   | 2.5   | 2.5   | 2.5   | 2.7   | 2.8   | 2.5   |
| Croatia                         | 3.5   | 3.1   | 3.0   | 1.7   | 1.6   | 1.7   | 1.8   | 1.8   | 2.7   | 1.7   |
| Czech Republic                  | 2.5   | 2.8   | 2.7   | 2.8   | 2.8   | 2.8   | 2.7   | 2.7   | 2.7   | 2.7   |
| Hungary                         | 1.6   | 1.4   | 1.7   | 2.2   | 1.9   | 3.2   | 3.1   | 3.6   | 1.7   | 3.0   |
| Poland                          | 3.6   | 3.8   | 3.7   | 3.6   | 3.6   | 3.4   | 3.0   | 3.0   | 3.7   | 3.2   |
| Romania                         | -0.7  | -0.8  | 0.3   | 2.8   | 3.1   | 2.9   | 2.6   | 2.7   | 0.6   | 2.8   |
| Turkey                          | 3.2   | 2.8   | 3.6   | 3.8   | 4.4   | 5.5   | 5.2   | 4.9   | 3.4   | 5.0   |
| Serbia                          | 3.5   | 3.0   | 3.1   | 2.6   | 2.8   | 3.2   | 3.3   | 3.6   | 3.0   | 3.2   |
| Azerbaijan                      | 3.0   | 2.0   | 4.0   | 1.0   | 3.0   | 3.5   | 2.0   | 3.5   | 2.5   | 3.0   |
| Kazakhstan                      | 4.0   | 5.0   | 5.0   | 6.0   | 5.0   | 4.8   | 4.0   | 4.0   | 5.0   | 4.5   |
| Russia                          | 1.0   | 1.0   | 0.5   | -0.5  | 0.0   | 0.5   | 1.0   | 1.5   | 0.5   | 0.8   |
| Uzbekistan                      | 6.5   | 6.3   | 6.0   | 7.0   | 6.5   | 5.5   | 6.0   | 6.0   | 6.5   | 6.0   |
| Ukraine                         | 2.1   | 2.6   | 2.5   | 2.8   | 3.2   | 3.4   | 3.5   | 3.5   | 2.5   | 3.4   |
| China                           | 4.6   | 4.6   | 4.7   | 4.5   | 4.2   | 4.9   | 4.4   | 4.4   | 4.6   | 4.5   |
| India                           | 6.5   | 6.6   | 6.8   | 7.0   | 6.5   | 6.5   | 6.5   | 6.5   | 6.7   | 6.5   |
| Indonesia                       | 4.8   | 4.9   | 5.0   | 5.0   | 5.0   | 5.0   | 5.0   | 5.0   | 4.9   | 5.0   |
| Korea                           | 2.4   | 2.4   | 1.5   | 2.3   | 1.8   | 1.8   | 1.9   | 1.8   | 2.2   | 1.8   |
| Philippines                     | 4.0   | 4.5   | 6.0   | 6.2   | 6.0   | 6.0   | 6.0   | 6.0   | 5.2   | 6.0   |
| Singapore                       | 4.5   | 4.0   | 3.0   | 2.0   | 1.8   | 1.8   | 1.8   | 1.8   | 3.4   | 1.8   |
| Taiwan                          | 10.2  | 7.4   | 6.9   | 3.1   | 4.0   | 4.6   | 5.0   | 5.1   | 6.7   | 4.7   |

Norway: Forecasts are mainland GDP

Source: ING estimates

## CPI Forecasts

| YoY% (avg)     | 1Q26F | 2Q26F | 3Q26F | 4Q26F | 1Q27F | 2Q27F | 3Q27F | 4Q27F | 2026F | 2027F |
|----------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| US             | 2.5   | 3.8   | 3.5   | 3.2   | 2.8   | 2.0   | 1.9   | 2.1   | 3.3   | 2.2   |
| Japan          | 1.7   | 2.4   | 2.4   | 2.3   | 2.6   | 1.8   | 1.8   | 1.6   | 2.2   | 2.0   |
| Germany        | 2.2   | 3.2   | 3.2   | 3.0   | 3.0   | 2.2   | 2.1   | 2.1   | 2.9   | 2.3   |
| France         | 1.1   | 2.4   | 2.2   | 2.3   | 1.9   | 1.1   | 0.8   | 1.5   | 2.0   | 1.3   |
| UK             | 3.0   | 2.4   | 3.5   | 3.4   | 3.2   | 2.9   | 1.9   | 2.1   | 3.1   | 2.5   |
| Italy          | 1.5   | 2.3   | 2.6   | 2.6   | 2.2   | 1.7   | 1.6   | 1.9   | 2.3   | 1.8   |
| Canada         | 2.1   | 2.8   | 2.9   | 2.5   | 2.1   | 1.7   | 1.8   | 2.0   | 2.6   | 1.9   |
| Australia      | 3.7   | 3.7   | 3.2   | 3.2   | 3.0   | 3.0   | 3.0   | 3.0   | 3.5   | 3.0   |
| Eurozone       | 2.0   | 3.2   | 3.1   | 2.7   | 2.6   | 1.9   | 1.8   | 2.0   | 2.8   | 2.1   |
| Austria        | 2.3   | 2.7   | 2.6   | 2.3   | 2.2   | 1.9   | 1.8   | 2.0   | 2.5   | 2.0   |
| Spain          | 2.6   | 3.3   | 2.8   | 2.6   | 2.2   | 2.2   | 2.1   | 2.1   | 2.8   | 2.1   |
| Netherlands    | 2.3   | 2.5   | 3.0   | 3.1   | 2.6   | 2.3   | 1.7   | 1.6   | 2.7   | 2.0   |
| Belgium        | 1.8   | 3.4   | 3.3   | 3.0   | 2.8   | 2.0   | 1.9   | 1.9   | 3.0   | 2.2   |
| Greece         | 3.1   | 3.5   | 3.6   | 3.1   | 2.7   | 2.0   | 2.2   | 2.2   | 3.3   | 2.3   |
| Portugal       | 2.2   | 2.9   | 2.6   | 2.4   | 2.0   | 2.0   | 1.9   | 1.9   | 2.5   | 2.0   |
| Switzerland    | 0.4   | 1.1   | 1.0   | 0.7   | 0.6   | 0.6   | 0.8   | 0.8   | 0.8   | 0.7   |
| Bulgaria       | 3.3   | 3.7   | 2.3   | 2.5   | 2.4   | 2.3   | 2.5   | 2.6   | 3.0   | 2.5   |
| Croatia        | 3.8   | 4.1   | 3.3   | 3.2   | 2.4   | 2.6   | 2.7   | 3.1   | 3.6   | 2.7   |
| Czech Republic | 1.5   | 1.8   | 1.6   | 2.1   | 2.5   | 2.3   | 2.3   | 2.3   | 1.7   | 2.3   |
| Hungary        | 1.9   | 3.4   | 3.6   | 3.9   | 4.0   | 4.2   | 3.8   | 3.4   | 3.2   | 3.8   |
| Poland         | 2.5   | 3.6   | 3.7   | 3.3   | 3.1   | 2.2   | 2.0   | 2.3   | 3.2   | 2.4   |
| Romania        | 9.7   | 10.4  | 6.0   | 5.4   | 4.2   | 4.1   | 3.9   | 3.7   | 7.9   | 4.0   |
| Turkey         | 31.0  | 28.6  | 26.3  | 25.5  | 21.6  | 20.7  | 19.0  | 18.3  | 28.1  | 20.3  |
| Serbia         | 2.6   | 3.0   | 2.6   | 3.4   | 3.3   | 3.5   | 3.8   | 4.2   | 3.0   | 3.8   |
| Azerbaijan     | 5.8   | 5.5   | 4.9   | 4.6   | 4.3   | 4.5   | 4.7   | 4.9   | 5.2   | 4.6   |
| Kazakhstan     | 11.8  | 11.0  | 10.3  | 10.4  | 10.0  | 9.3   | 8.6   | 8.1   | 10.9  | 9.0   |
| Russia         | 5.9   | 5.4   | 4.8   | 5.3   | 4.5   | 4.8   | 5.3   | 4.7   | 5.3   | 4.8   |
| Uzbekistan     | 7.4   | 7.1   | 7.0   | 7.7   | 8.0   | 7.7   | 7.6   | 7.6   | 7.3   | 7.7   |
| Ukraine        | 9.2   | 8.5   | 7.5   | 7.0   | 6.5   | 6.3   | 6.1   | 5.7   | 8.1   | 6.2   |
| China          | 0.9   | 1.1   | 1.4   | 1.3   | 1.6   | 1.1   | 1.1   | 1.1   | 1.2   | 1.3   |
| India          | 3.0   | 3.7   | 4.1   | 4.3   | 4.5   | 4.8   | 4.8   | 5.0   | 3.8   | 5.0   |
| Indonesia      | 3.0   | 2.3   | 2.5   | 2.5   | 2.5   | 2.5   | 3.0   | 3.0   | 2.6   | 2.5   |
| Korea          | 2.1   | 3.0   | 2.5   | 2.1   | 1.8   | 1.3   | 1.9   | 2.2   | 2.4   | 1.8   |
| Philippines    | 2.5   | 3.0   | 3.2   | 3.0   | 3.0   | 3.0   | 3.0   | 3.0   | 3.0   | 3.0   |
| Singapore      | 1.6   | 1.8   | 1.9   | 1.8   | 2.0   | 2.0   | 2.0   | 2.0   | 1.8   | 2.0   |
| Taiwan         | 1.4   | 2.6   | 2.5   | 1.9   | 1.5   | 1.3   | 1.4   | 1.4   | 2.1   | 1.4   |

\*Quarterly forecasts are quarterly average; yearly forecasts are average over the year, HICP for Eurozone economies

Source: ING estimates

## Oil and Natural Gas Forecasts (avg)

|                     | 1Q26F | 2Q26F | 3Q26F | 4Q26F | 1Q27F | 2Q27F | 3Q27F | 4Q27F | 2026F | 2027F |
|---------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| Brent (\$/bbl)      | 76    | 91    | 85    | 77    | 72    | 70    | 67    | 63    | 82    | 68    |
| Dutch TTF (EUR/MWh) | 39    | 50    | 38    | 38    | 34    | 28    | 27    | 30    | 41    | 30    |

Source: ING estimates

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